Berson was getting a job at the University of Southern California, and he and Bella would be leaving soon. That was the worst of making friends in the academic world—all its members were peripatetic.

Also present were Roger and Carolyn Newman, who were friends of the Bersons originally, and with whom we had often hobnobbed that first year in Boston. Roger was leaving, too, for Cal Tech. I remember Roger best for a lesson he taught me, perhaps inadvertently.

My clipping service had been sending me all kinds of reviews of Pebble in the Sky, and I had bought a scrapbook and had been carefully pasting them up. On June 24, when the Newmans and Bersons were visiting our attic apartment, I brought out the book and went over the reviews very pridefully for them.

During the course of that, I heard Roger say in a very low voice, to himself rather than to anyone else, "The old lady shows her medals." (That was, of course, the name of a play by James M. Barrie.)

I pretended I hadn't heard, closed the book as soon as I decently could, and put it away.

From that day on, I have never showed my reviews to anyone nor, as far as is humanly possible, done anything that could be construed as showing my medals. 2 Thank you, Roger Newman, wherever you are.

2 Of course, you might construe this autobiography as a case of showing my medals, but I'm doing my level best to show my boobie prizes as well.

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On June 19, we put down a deposit of $25 on a new Plymouth that would cost us $1,650 altogether. I wasn't satisfied with just the driving lessons, either. I invited my fellow instructor, Fabian Lionetti (a quiet fellow with a permanently furrowed forehead and a somewhat hesitant manner of speaking), to dinner, after which he took me for a long drive in his car, describing what he was doing and why, and giving me numerous practical lessons on car maintenance and car expense. It was a little frightening, but I was unshaken. I had to have a car.

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On June 23, I received the September 1950 issue of Weird Tales, with "Legal